Skechers Email Review: “■ Last day to redeem your voucher”

Walker · US market · Executive summary first, evidence after

Executive Summary

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Email Review: "■ Last day to redeem your voucher" — adidas adiClub

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1. Executive Summary

A well-structured urgency email nudging adiClub members to redeem an expiring 15% voucher. The layout is clean and the hierarchy is sensible, but a critical character-encoding bug in the voucher section damages credibility at the most important moment, and a secondary module dilutes the urgency focus. The email does enough to drive redemption for engaged members, but leaves conversion on the table.

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2. Business Impact Score: 6 / 10

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3. What's Working

Urgency framing is clear. "Last day to redeem" in the subject + product picks upfront creates a coherent moment of action.

Promo code is prominently displayed. The code WELCOME-1325-HMW is surfaced in a button-style element above the REDEEM ONLINE CTA — hard to miss.

Two redemption paths offered. Online checkout + in-store option (show email to staff) covers both use cases cleanly.

Product picks above the fold. Three product tiles with visible imagery give members something concrete to shop toward.

Clean visual hierarchy. The email reads top-to-bottom without confusion — voucher → profile CTA → app download.

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4. What's Weak

Critical encoding bug in the voucher headline. The headline renders as HEREÂ€™S 15% OFF instead of HERE'S 15% OFF. This is visible in the email body and undermines trust at the highest-value moment in the email.

Profile completion module undercuts urgency. "Complete Your Profile for 50 Points" is a low-stakes retention ask that competes directly with the time-sensitive voucher message. It belongs in a different send.

Product tiles are small and under-merchandised. Three tiny thumbnail images with no clear product names or prices visible — they don't create enough desire to drive a click.

No explicit deadline reinforcement in the body. The subject says "last day" but the body only references "March 24, 2026" in fine print. A visible countdown or bolded expiry date in the hero would strengthen conversion.

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5. Recommendations

Fix the encoding bug immediately. The HEREÂ€™S rendering is a production-level defect. Audit the voucher content block for character encoding issues before the send window closes.

Remove or defer the profile completion module. This is not the right send for it. Strip it out or move it below the app CTA to reduce cognitive load on the primary action.

Add expiry date to the hero. Make "Expires March 24" bold and prominent inside the voucher section, not buried in an asterisked footnote.

Upgrade the product tiles. Larger images, visible product names, and price callouts would make "top picks" feel like actual recommendations rather than decorative thumbnails.

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6. Bottom Line

The email has sound bones — urgency-led, clear promo code, dual redemption paths — but the character encoding bug in the voucher headline is a credibility wound that needs to be fixed. If the encoding issue is resolved and the profile module removed, this becomes a solid 8/10 conversion email.

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7. Evidence

*Overall purpose: Urgency-driven reminder to redeem an expiring 15% adiClub member voucher before March 24, 2026.

*Hero / primary value proposition: "TOP PICKS FOR YOU" leads, followed by three product thumbnails and a plain-language reminder about the expiring voucher. Functional but the product images don't do enough selling.

*Membership / benefits section: The voucher block is the core membership moment. It shows the promo code WELCOME-1325-HMW, two CTAs (code display + REDEEM ONLINE), and terms (*valid on full-priced items until March 24). Critically damaged by the HEREÂ€™S encoding bug in the headline.

*Product discoverability / recommendation modules: Three thumbnail-sized product images in a horizontal row. No product names or prices visible at this render size — low discoverability.

*Utility / secondary modules: (1) Complete Your Profile for 50 Points — out-of-place in an urgency email. (2) The Ultimate App for Members — App Store / Google Play badges. Both feel like filler in this context.

*Bugs / friction / clarity issues:

VISIBLE BUG: Voucher headline reads HEREÂ€™S 15% OFF — broken UTF-8 apostrophe rendering as mojibake characters. Clearly visible in the rendered email.

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Technical Audit

Technical Audit — adidas "■ Last day to redeem your voucher"

*From: adidas

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1. Technical Summary

Multiple high-severity infrastructure issues are present: all four brand fonts return 403 from S3, staging CDN hostnames are embedded in a production send, and one CTA link contains illegal control characters that will break across all clients. Plain-text payload is also dominated by raw URLs, creating a deliverability risk.

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2. Link & Tracking Issues

*[FAIL] Malformed CTA URL — control characters in token

The following link contains a literal space and unencoded + characters inside the tkn query parameter, making it an invalid URL per RFC 3986:

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https://go.adidas.com/ihha/lyxsr85w?pid=sfmc&tkn;=X3GGIjX0...NsD2L0d0vfg88EyoFZ03SHIY+qRCOV5...

`

The QA checker confirms: URL can't contain control characters. This will render the link non-functional in strict clients (iOS Mail, Gmail Android) and may cause click-tracking failures even where the redirect partially works.

*[WARN] 22 tracking links skipped

All go.adidas.com redirect links were not probed. Destination URL validity is unconfirmed.

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3. Rendering & Accessibility

*[FAIL] All 8 brand font files return HTTP 403

Every @font-face src in is inaccessible:

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https://s3-eu-west-1.amazonaws.com/adidas-adl/foundation/dist/adidas/assets/fonts/adidas/AdihausDIN-Regular.woff2 → 403

https://s3-eu-west-1.amazonaws.com/adidas-adl/foundation/dist/adidas/assets/fonts/adidas/AdihausDIN-Bold.woff2 → 403

https://s3-eu-west-1.amazonaws.com/adidas-adl/foundation/dist/adidas/assets/fonts/adidas/adineuePRO-Regular.woff2 → 403

https://s3-eu-west-1.amazonaws.com/adidas-adl/foundation/dist/adidas/assets/fonts/adidas/adineuePRO-Bold.woff2 → 403

(+ 4 corresponding .ttf / .woff fallbacks — all 403)

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All clients that support webfonts (Apple Mail, Outlook on Mac, iOS) will fall back to the mso-font-alt: Arial stack. Brand typography will not render for any recipient.

*[FAIL] Staging CDN hostname in production email

Multiple images are served from image.staging.link.adidas.com rather than image.link.adidas.com:

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https://image.staging.link.adidas.com/lib/fe6515707c62007e7715/m/21/2373748f-4913-4dfd-88b6-ca5c712d055b.gif (appears 7×)

https://image.staging.link.adidas.com/lib/fe6515707c62007e7715/m/1/b9aa5d2a-c492-4e2f-a045-d2b785fd93a0.jpg

https://image.staging.link.adidas.com/lib/fe6515707c62007e7715/m/1/5bf3fd66-079e-49c6-9995-58885dce1ee1.jpg

https://image.staging.link.adidas.com/lib/fe6515707c62007e7715/m/104/6c9cdf12-b118-4679-a55e-9d223a559bbc.png (appears 2×)

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If the staging environment is access-controlled or deprioritized under load, these images will fail to render for production recipients.

*[WARN] 2 images served over HTTP (non-HTTPS)

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http://image.link.adidas.com/lib/fe6515707c62007e7715/m/3/966ef092-a6d7-47fd-8703-d364ac06d9e7.png

http://image.link.adidas.com/lib/fe6515707c62007e7715/m/1/37231f63-3f72-48f3-8047-2650e11742e8.gif

`

Gmail and Outlook.com proxy all images over HTTPS; mixed-content images may be blocked or show broken in strict clients.

*[WARN] 15 images missing alt text

All flagged images — including the recurring 2373748f...gif spacer/tracker (7 instances) and content images — have empty or absent alt attributes. Screen readers will skip them entirely; clients with images disabled will show blank space with no context.

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4. Personalization & Merge Tokens

No unresolved merge token syntax (e.g., %%, {{, [%) is visible in the provided HTML excerpt. The tracking URL includes what appear to be correctly resolved subscriber/campaign identifiers (cm_mmca3=ILDCWJD70W1BE32X, cm_mmca4=4134869). Cannot confirm full personalization surface from truncated source.

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5. Compliance

*[WARN] SPF/DKIM authentication status unknown

The Authentication-Results header was not captured via the AgentMail relay. SPF and DKIM pass/fail status is unverified for us-news.adidas.com. Cannot confirm DMARC alignment.

*[WARN] Plain-text version is URL-heavy

Plain-text body: 16,013 of 18,912 characters (85%) are URLs. This is well above the 70% threshold that spam filters flag as link-stuffing. It suggests the plain-text version is auto-generated from HTML without stripping tracking URLs — a common pattern but a measurable deliverability risk, particularly with conservative ISPs.

CAN-SPAM physical address and unsubscribe mechanism could not be confirmed from the truncated source; these should be verified in the full HTML footer.

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6. Email-to-Site Continuity

The one fully-visible destination URL targets /us/welcome with the following attribution stack:

cm_mmc (Coremetrics/IBM): AdiEmail_CLC-_-None-_-MemOnb_Comms5-_-Marketing-_-preferences

AppsFlyer: af_adset=MemOnb_Comms5, af_ad=preferences, af_channel=Welcome, af_reengagement_window=30d

UTM parameter alignment appears consistent with a welcome/onboarding series. However, the link is currently broken due to the control character issue noted in §2, so continuity cannot be confirmed end-to-end.

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7. Recommendations

| Priority | Issue | Action |

|---|---|---|

| P0 | Malformed tkn parameter with control characters | URL-encode all token values; spaces → %20, + → %2B before insertion |

| P0 | Staging image CDN in production | Replace all image.staging.link.adidas.com hostnames with image.link.adidas.com before any future send |

| P1 | All font files returning 403 | Audit S3 bucket policy on adidas-adl; restore public read ACL or migrate font hosting to a CDN with guaranteed public access |

| P1 | 2 HTTP image sources | Update to https:// — both are already on image.link.adidas.com so the HTTPS path should resolve |

| P2 | Authentication-Results not captured | Confirm SPF (include:us-news.adidas.com) and DKIM (d=adidas.com) pass in delivered headers; add DMARC monitoring if not already in place |

| P2 | Plain-text URL saturation (85%) | Generate plain-text version with link shortening or descriptive anchor text instead of raw tracking URLs |

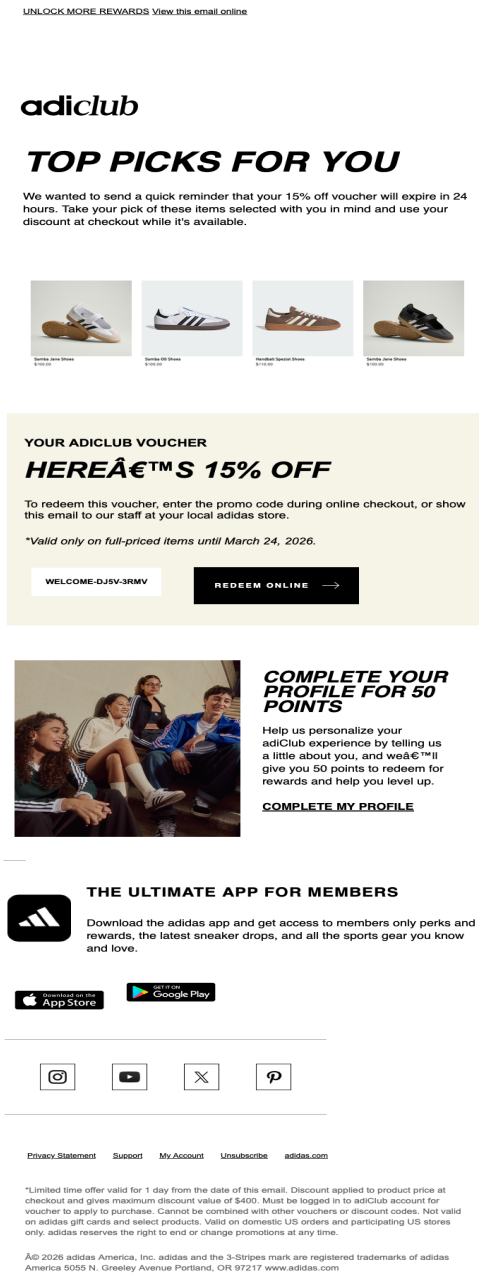
| P3 | Missing alt text on 15 images | Add descriptive alt for content images; use alt="" explicitly on decorative spacers/trackers |

Business Impact Score: n/a

Automated QA

Pass rate: 31% • Issues: 9 • Warnings: 2

Visual Reference



UNLOCK MORE REWARDS View this email online

adiclub

TOP PICKS FOR YOU

We wanted to send a quick reminder that your 15% off voucher will expire in 24 hours. Take your pick of these items selected with you in mind and use your discount at checkout while it's available.

Samba Jane Shoes $100.00
Samba OG Shoes $100.00
Handball Spezial Shoes $110.00
Samba Jane Shoes $100.00

YOUR ADICLUB VOUCHER

HEREÂ€™S 15% OFF

To redeem this voucher, enter the promo code during online checkout, or show this email to our staff at your local adidas store.

*Valid only on full-priced items until March 24, 2026.

WELCOME-DJ5V-3RMV

REDEEM ONLINE →

COMPLETE YOUR PROFILE FOR 50 POINTS

Help us personalize your adiClub experience by telling us a little about you, and weâ€™ll give you 50 points to redeem for rewards and help you level up.

COMPLETE MY PROFILE

THE ULTIMATE APP FOR MEMBERS

Download the adidas app and get access to members only perks and rewards, the latest sneaker drops, and all the sports gear you know and love.

Download on the App Store

GET IT ON Google Play

Privacy Statement Support My Account Unsubscribe adidas.com

*Limited time offer valid for 1 day from the date of this email. Discount applied to product price at checkout and gives maximum discount value of $400. Must be logged in to adiClub account for voucher to apply to purchase. Cannot be combined with other vouchers or discount codes. Not valid on adidas gift cards and select products. Valid on domestic US orders and participating US stores only. adidas reserves the right to end or change promotions at any time.

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Visual source: hosted web-view render when available.

Reference Artifacts

Saved HTML: /Users/alontsang/.openclaw-walker/workspace/reports/email-artifacts/2026-03-23-last-day-to-redeem-your-voucher/message.html

Saved message JSON: /Users/alontsang/.openclaw-walker/workspace/reports/email-artifacts/2026-03-23-last-day-to-redeem-your-voucher/message.json

Bottom Line

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